

Fourteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Year A — July 5, 2026

PC-S38-A: U.S. Roman Missal, Third Edition; Lectionary no. 100

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This working proper exposition studies PC-S38-A, the Fourteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time, Year A, on July 5, 2026, using the U.S. *Roman Missal, Third Edition* and U.S. Lectionary no. 100. It is source-audited at the stated layers and identifies protected texts through citations, Latin incipits, and original summaries. It is not publication-final: full U.S. altar-book English-oratio collation and independent theological review remain outstanding.

Textual Variable Parts

Textual unit	Text / citation
Introductory Rites	
Entrance Antiphon	<i>Cf. Ps. 48:10–11; mercy in the Temple</i>
Collect	<i>Deus, qui in Filii tui humilitate. . .</i>
Liturgy of the Word	
First Reading	Zech. 9:9–10
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 145:1–2, 8–9, 10–11, 13–14; A: <i>cf. Ps. 145:1</i> ; B: <i>Alleluia</i>
Second Reading	Rom. 8:9, 11–13
Gospel Acclamation	<i>Cf. Matt. 11:25</i>
Gospel	Matt. 11:25–30
Liturgy of the Eucharist	
Prayer over Offerings	<i>Oblatio nos. . . tuo nomini dicata purificet</i>
Communion Antiphon	A: Ps. 34:9; taste and refuge; B: Matt. 11:28; the burdened invited
Prayer after Communion	<i>Tantis. . . repleti muneribus</i>

Study Guide: Scripture and Liturgical Context

Canonical order governs this inventory. Composition and narrated event remain distinct; marked Cf. texts are adaptations rather than claims of verbatim quotation. Dates are responsible orientations, not assertions of autograph precision.

Textual unit / alternative	Citation	Location	Date
Communion A	Ps. 34:9	Kingdom of Israel; exact composition place unknown	Davidic attribution traditional; final date unknown
The psalm's inherited heading places David during flight from Saul, but modern study cannot recover the poem's precise author, place, or date. Its wisdom invitation moves from afflicted prayer to shared instruction in reverent trust; the Communion antiphon appoints one short clause from that larger invitation.			
Entrance	<i>Cf.</i> Ps. 48:10–11	Jerusalem sanctuary in the poem's cultic horizon; composition place unknown	Korahite attribution traditional; date unknown
Psalm 48 praises Zion as the city of the great King and receives divine mercy within the Temple. The sons-of-Korah heading associates it with Israel's sanctuary tradition, not with a recoverable autograph event. The Missal adapts its Temple, mercy, praise, and world-embracing horizon for the gathering Church.			
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 145:1–2, 8–9, 10–11, 13–14	Israel; exact place unknown	Davidic attribution traditional; likely late final form, date disputed
The alphabetic hymn praises God's kingship through concrete qualities: graciousness, compassion, fidelity, universal care, and support for those who fall. Its inherited Davidic title and its likely later literary shaping are different kinds of judgment. In this Mass it answers the oracle of the peaceful king without losing its direct address to God.			
First Reading	Zech. 9:9–10	Judah and Jerusalem; exact collection place unknown	Postexilic period; final date of Zech. 9–14 disputed
The book's heading names Zechariah son of Berechiah in the Persian period. Modern Catholic study commonly distinguishes the undated collection in chapters 9–14 from chapters 1–8 and places its final form later, while leaving authorship and date debated. Daughter Zion is summoned to rejoice because a just, saving, humble king comes; war instruments disappear and peace reaches the nations.			
Acclamation / Gospel / Communion B	<i>Cf.</i> Matt. 11:25; Matt. 11:25–30; Matt. 11:28	Palestine in traditional attribution; Antioch in Syria plausible for the final Greek Gospel	Traditional early apostolic date; modern majority c. AD 80–90
Narrated event	Matt. 11:20–30	Galilee; exact place unrecorded	Public ministry, c. AD 28–29
Ancient tradition identifies Matthew the Apostle writing for Jewish believers in Palestine; the modern majority regards the final Greek author as unknown, dates the Gospel after AD 70, and often proposes Antioch. The narrated scene follows Jesus' rebuke of Galilean towns. He thanks the Father for revelation to the little ones, states the Son's unique knowledge and mediation, and summons the burdened to learn his meekness.			
Second Reading	Rom. 8:9, 11–13	Corinth, Achaia (present-day Greece)	c. AD 57
Paul writes to mixed Jewish and Gentile house churches at Rome near the end of his eastern mission. Romans 8 contrasts life governed by the Spirit with life governed by disordered flesh and directs hope toward bodily resurrection. Lectionary 100 omits verse 10, then resumes with the Spirit who raised Jesus and the obligation to mortify evil deeds.			

Study Guide: Liturgical Movement and Textual Relationships

Governing account

The officially correlated strand presents one royal paradox: God's reign arrives in a king whose strength is humble and whose yoke gives rest. Beside it, Romans continues its own apostolic course, locating Christian freedom in the Spirit who raises bodies and puts sinful deeds to death. The offering and Communion texts carry these themes toward purification, salvation, and enduring praise.

Four-stage movement at a glance

- 1. Gathered by mercy — Entrance; Collect.** Temple mercy and the Son's humility gather and raise a fallen people.
- 2. The humble King speaks — First Reading; Psalm; Acclamation; Gospel.** Peaceful rule and filial revelation form the officially correlated strand without erasing each text's history.
- 3. Freedom under the Spirit — Second Reading.** Paul's semi-continuous strand calls hearers to Spirit-enabled mortification and bodily hope.
- 4. Purified, fed, praising — Prayer over Offerings; Communion; Prayer after Communion.** The appointed prayers and antiphons order disciples toward salvation and praise.

1. Mercy gathers those who cannot raise themselves (*Entrance; Collect*)

The Entrance begins with received mercy rather than religious achievement. Its Temple setting makes the gathering ecclesial, while praise reaches beyond one sanctuary. The Collect then attributes the world's raising to the Son's humility. These texts establish dependence before the readings specify kingship, Spirit, and discipleship; because they belong to Week XIV in every cycle, the relation is liturgical juxtaposition, not proved historical design.

2. Royal power takes the form of meekness (*First Reading; Psalm; Acclamation; Gospel*)

Zechariah removes the normal machinery of conquest from the king's arrival: humble riding, abolished weapons, peace proclaimed outward. Psalm 145 answers by praising the Lord whose kingdom is manifested through compassion, fidelity, and support. Matthew then gives the correlation its Christological center. Jesus does not merely recommend gentleness; as Son he reveals the Father, and as the meek teacher he summons disciples beneath his yoke.

3. Rest and mortification are not rivals (*Second Reading; Gospel*)

Romans remains a semi-continuous strand, yet it prevents sentimental readings of rest. The Spirit's indwelling generates obligation: evil deeds are to be put to death. Chrysostom and Augustine insist that this mortification concerns disordered action rather than hatred of the created body. The Gospel's light yoke likewise names obedient discipleship, not inactivity. Liturgical co-occurrence permits this qualified comparison without claiming that Paul was selected to explain Matthew.

4. Gift becomes purified life and enduring praise (*Prayer over Offerings; Communion; Prayer after Communion*)

The Prayer over the Offerings asks that worship purify and redirect conduct. Communion Antiphon A stresses tasting and refuge; alternative B repeats Christ's invitation to the burdened. The final prayer asks that great gifts issue in salvation and unceasing praise, making reception a beginning of transformed life rather than a terminus.

Study Guide: Theological and Spiritual Synthesis

The peaceful king promised to Zion and the meek Son who reveals the Father disclose a form of divine rule in which power serves peace and authority teaches the burdened. Psalm 145 answers with praise of the gracious sovereign, so meekness appears as the exercise of faithful strength rather than its absence.

Romans gives this discipleship an interior and bodily depth. The Spirit who raised Jesus dwells in believers and enables them to put sinful deeds to death without treating the body itself as evil. Receptive littleness, Spirit-enabled obedience, and Christ's fitting yoke belong together as graced participation rather than self-salvation.

The celebration looks toward universal peace, resurrection, saving reception, and enduring praise. Communion may voice either Psalm 34's invitation to taste and seek refuge or Christ's summons to the burdened; both paths direct the assembly toward life received from God and lived under the gentle kingship of the Son.

Study Guide: Commentary on the Texts

Received mercy and the humiliation that raises (*Entrance; Collect*)

Psalm 48's cultic geography is exacting: mercy is received *in the midst* of God's Temple, while praise extends to earth's ends. Gathering is neither private consolation nor possession of God by one place. The antiphon lets the Church enter as recipient and witness.

The Collect's Latin axis joins the Son's *humilitas*, a fallen world, release from sin's servitude, and enduring joy. Humility is therefore neither self-contempt nor mere style. It is first Christological: the Son descends and raises. Only then is it moral, because the raised people may share holy gladness.

A king without the instruments of domination (*First Reading; Responsorial Psalm*)

Zechariah 9:9–10 holds apparently contrary predicates together. The king is just and saving, yet humble; royal, yet riding the ordinary animal of peaceful entry; victorious, yet abolishing chariot, horse, and warrior's bow. His dominion from sea to sea is not an unlimited version of coercive empire. The text interprets its scope through the peace he proclaims to the nations.

The Christian reading does not cancel the oracle's address to Zion or Israel's hope. Matthew's passion narrative explicitly receives the entry image elsewhere, while this Sunday pairs the oracle with Jesus' self-identification as meek. That liturgical correlation warrants Christological fulfillment; it does not authorize contempt for the Jewish people or reduction of the first reading to a coded prediction with no original communal horizon.

Psalm 145 responds with a vocabulary of divine kingship that is ethical rather than merely titular. The Lord is gracious, compassionate, good to all, faithful, and near to those bowed down. The textual refrain names God as King; the authorized *Alleluia* response instead lets paschal praise frame the same verses. Neither changes the appointed strophes. The Psalm also qualifies human hopes: the assembly praises God as King while receiving the promised human royal figure in relation to him.

The Spirit's dwelling and the body's future (*Second Reading*)

Romans 8:9 locates Christian existence by indwelling: belonging to Christ is inseparable from the Spirit of Christ. After the appointed omission of verse 10, verse 11 grounds hope in the Spirit who raised Jesus and will give life to mortal bodies. The body is mortal and awaits vivification; it is not the evil that must be destroyed.

Verses 12–13 then announce an obligation without returning to self-salvation. Hearers are debtors, but not to disordered flesh as a ruling power. They must put evil deeds to death *by the Spirit*. Chrysostom's direct exposition treats the warning as real while distinguishing sinful deeds from bodily substance. Augustine likewise keeps divine aid and human action together. Grace neither ratifies passivity nor turns obedience into autonomous achievement.

The Lectionary's omission of verse 10 must remain visible. It creates a proclamation moving from Spirit-defined identity directly to resurrection and obligation. Commentary may consult the complete chapter, but it may not

silently insert an unappointed verse or imply that worshippers heard it.

Revelation to the little and the yoke of the Son (*Acclamation; Gospel*)

The acclamation adapts Matthew 11:25 and performs what it says: the assembly blesses the Father and receives the Gospel as gift rather than mastery. “Little ones” does not canonize ignorance or forbid disciplined study. In context it contrasts receptive dependence with the self-securing posture that refuses Jesus’ works and wisdom.

The Gospel’s center is relational before it is therapeutic. The Son receives all from the Father; only Father and Son know one another in the unique manner expressed here; those to whom the Son reveals enter by gift. The invitation to the burdened follows this claim. Rest is communion under the revealing Son, not a technique detached from his identity.

The yoke image prevents an interpretation of rest as absence of claim. A yoke joins a learner to directed labor; Jesus calls hearers to take and learn. Its goodness lies in the teacher’s meek and humble heart and in the fittingness of his lordship. Christian meekness therefore cannot mean acquiescing in abuse or refusing duties of protection. It is strength governed by truth and charity under Christ.

Direct reception and its boundary

The repository-audited direct witnesses used here expound Romans 8, not Matthew 11 or the complete formulary. Chrysostom, Augustine, and Aquinas support Spirit-enabled mortification and filial life. The Gospel analysis is close exegesis governed by its literary context and the Church’s teaching on the Kingdom; no patristic unanimity about every image is claimed.

Purification and heavenly conduct (*Prayer over Offerings*)

The Prayer over the Offerings moves from a dedicated oblation to purification and heavenly conduct. It does not identify the gifts with moral effort or make purification the congregation’s purchase. God receives the Church’s offering within Christ’s action and is asked to transform those who offer. Because the prayer is common to A/B/C, relating it to the meek yoke is a later synthesis rather than a Lectionary claim.

Two Communion paths and one final petition (*Communion A; Communion B; Prayer after Communion*)

Communion Antiphon A appoints Psalm 34’s invitation to taste and see within sacramental reception. Its full psalmic context joins tasting to blessing, seeking, deliverance, instruction, and refuge. It does not reduce Eucharistic truth to a pleasant feeling; objective gift and fitting disposition remain distinct.

Alternative B repeats Matthew 11:28 and gives this cycle a particularly transparent Gospel–Communion correspondence. On this path, the burdened hear the same invitation at proclamation and sacramental approach. The two appointed antiphons remain distinct alternatives, each with its own textual contribution.

The Prayer after Communion asks that recipients filled with great gifts receive salvation and continue in praise. Its order matters: divine gift precedes enduring response. “Unceasing” praise cannot mean continuous speech; it names a life ordered toward God, including work, rest, service, repentance, and the next Eucharistic gathering.

Study Guide: Further Interpretive Possibilities

The following are original editorial and AI-generated possibilities. They are attributed to none of the cited authorities, claim no historical compositional intent, and remain bounded by the source distinctions stated in each proposal.

The yoke as the peaceful king's mode of rule. (*First Reading; Gospel*) Zechariah removes war's equipment; Jesus gives a yoke. One possible liturgical reading is that the Messiah does not abolish authority but converts its form: coercive mastery yields to a teaching relation whose burden is fitted by the meek King. The proposal is pastorally fruitful wherever "gentleness" is confused with aimlessness. Its limit is historical: Matthew 11 does not quote Zechariah 9 here, and the Lectionary's official correlation does not prove that the two authors intended this exact contrast.

From being bowed down to taking up a yoke. (*Responsorial Psalm; Gospel; Communion B*) Psalm 145 praises God who raises those bowed down; Matthew summons the burdened to take Christ's yoke; Communion B may repeat the summons. The movement may suggest that salvation is not simply removal of every weight but liberation from crushing mastery for fitting discipleship. This synthesis can guard against both Pelagian exertion and passive quietism. It must not imply that God wills abuse as a spiritual burden or that medical, legal, or protective relief should be refused.

Mortal bodies at the table of rest. (*Second Reading; Communion A; Prayer after Communion*) Romans promises life to mortal bodies through the indwelling Spirit; Psalm 34's Communion invitation directs embodied tasting; the final prayer asks saving fruit from received gifts. Together they may disclose Christian rest as resurrection-oriented embodiment rather than escape from matter. The sources ground each endpoint, but no cited authority is claimed to join these three elements as one designed arc, and sacramental reception is not reducible to a symbol of bodily optimism.

Appendix: Liturgical Resolution

Liturgical Instance

Field	Resolved liturgical instance
Celebration	Fourteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time; Sunday rank; green.
Formula	PC-S38-A; canonical Year A target; dated U.S. occurrence 2026-07-05.
Books	U.S. <i>Roman Missal, Third Edition</i> (implemented 2011), Week XIV owner; U.S. <i>Lectionary for Mass</i> , Second Typical Edition, Volume I, no. 100.
Calendar scope	General Roman Calendar as implemented for the United States; national scope.
Cycle	Sunday Year A.
Textual branches	Two Responsorial Psalm responses and two Communion Antiphons.

Branch Resolution

Branch ID	Authority and trigger	Status	Units affected	Resolution
psalm-response-textual	Lectionary 100	Appointed alternative	Textual response marked <i>cf.</i> Ps. 145:1	Documented, not selected
psalm-response-alleluia	Lectionary 100	Appointed alternative	<i>Alleluia</i> response to the same Psalm verses	Documented, not selected
communion-antiphon-psalm-34	Week XIV formulary	Appointed alternative	Communion Antiphon A	Documented, not selected
communion-antiphon-matthew-11	Week XIV formulary	Appointed alternative	Communion Antiphon B	Documented, not selected

References

Liturgical and scriptural sources

- *Missale Romanum*, editio typica tertia (Vatican City, 2002), Week XIV, p. 464; the shared audit records exact owner evidence, the official 2008 variation-list result (Ordinary Time changes only at pp. 457 and 471; none at pp. 464–466), and the outstanding 2008 page-image typography/layout and U.S.-English collation.
- United States Conference of Catholic Bishops, *2026 Liturgical Calendar* and Lectionary 100 occurrence page, checked 2026-07-15.
- Bishops’ official *Antiphonary*, p. 74, corroborating the ICEL antiphon assignments; protected wording is not reproduced.
- Holy See, *General Instruction of the Roman Missal*, especially 46–90; approved *General Introduction to the Lectionary*, especially 65–69, 78–91, and 93–110.
- Holy Scripture: Psalms 34, 48, and 145; Zechariah 9; Matthew 11; Romans 8. Historical orientation used the corresponding *New American Bible, Revised Edition* introductions, texts, and notes at Zechariah, Matthew, and Romans.

Reception and doctrinal illumination

- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 14 on Romans*, direct treatment of Romans 8:12–17, working English text.
- St. Augustine, *Sermon 156* §§6–15, direct treatment of Romans 8:12–17, Latin text.
- St. Thomas Aquinas, *Commentary on Romans* VIII, lect. 3, nos. 634–651, Latin and English.
- *Catechism of the Catholic Church* 541–550, the Kingdom present in Christ and disclosed in his ministry; doctrinal illumination, not direct commentary on the Week XIV formulary.

Search Scope and Limitations

Formula. Lectionary 100, both Psalm responses, both Communion alternatives, and the Week XIV orations and antiphons were audited. **Historical study.** Every directly appointed scriptural passage and marked adaptation appears in canonical order, with Matthew’s composition separated from the narrated event. **Reception.** Repository-audited Chrysostom, Augustine, and Aquinas directly illuminate Romans 8; the Zechariah and Matthew commentary rests on textual context and identified doctrinal sources. **Rights.** Only citations, short incipits, and original summaries appear. **Outstanding.** Full U.S. altar-book English-oration collation and independent theological review; this working guide is not publication-final. **Audit trail.** instance/manifest.md; propers/verified.md; ../shared/ordinary-time/weeks/14/propers/verified.md; research/scope.md.

Generation Metadata

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